Supported single-arm chest press

Push / chest / 8-12 each side



START / handle beside chest FINISH / controlled press

MAIN: Pectoralis major: moves the upper arm forward and across the chest.

SECONDARY: Triceps extend the elbow; anterior deltoid assists. Scapular muscles guide the shoulder blade.

BASE / SUPPORT: Trunk muscles resist rotation; the chair and planted feet stabilize the pelvis and legs.

01 / Check the setup

Use a stable non-rolling chair and a secure anchor behind you near chest height. Keep the band beside the arm, away from the neck and face.

02 / Set the base and brace

Sit tall with both feet planted. Start with the handle beside the chest, neutral wrist and elbow below shoulder height. Let the shoulder blade move naturally.

03 / Move with control

Breathe out and press forward smoothly while keeping ribs and pelvis steady. Do not lean or twist to finish.

04 / Limit the range and return

Finish before the elbow locks; return only as far as the shoulder remains comfortable. Avoid a deep forced stretch behind the torso.

WATCH FOR: If the ribs flare, shoulder pinches or trunk turns, shorten the range and lower the load. EASIER: Use an unloaded press rehearsal or a comfortable wall press-up instead.

Soft joints, normal breathing. Colours describe exercise roles, not measured activation. Hidden muscles are named in text. No fixed resistance is prescribed.

Stop for pain, new numbness or weakness, dizziness, loss of grip, moving supports or damaged bands. Keep the recoil path clear. Follow manufacturer limits and individual clinical restrictions.

Sources: ACE - Resistance-band workout builder; NHS - Strength exercises. Full source links: project100.fit/downloads/kinetics/index.html